

Week 3: Truth

BIG IDEA

Students live in a post-truth, relativist culture that says you can create your own reality. But truth is what corresponds with reality, independent of anyone's opinion. Jesus' claim in John 14 is objective, either true or false, and understanding that leads students to genuine freedom in Christ.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Oxford's 2016 word of the year, 'post-truth,' captures the relativism students face daily: feelings and personal belief outweighing objective facts.
- When leaders present something as objectively true, students often hear only 'that's what you think,' a wall this lesson helps take down.
- Nothing else this year, Scripture's authority, the resurrection, God's existence, the problem of evil, can be discussed until students understand the nature of truth.
- Truth is what corresponds with reality, and coherence or practicality is not enough: Santa Claus makes sense to kids but does not line up with reality.
- Subjective truths, like a favorite ice cream flavor, are about the subject's experience; objective truths, like a shirt's color, hold regardless of anyone's opinion.
- Culture lumps Jesus with subjective truth, but John 14's 'I am the way' is an objective claim: if true, contradicting beliefs are false.

SCRIPTURE

John 14:6

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What is the difference between a subjective truth and an objective truth? Give an example of each.
2. Why do people put belief in Jesus on the subjective side, and why does John 14 not allow that?
3. Can something make sense and be practical but still not be true? How would you tell?
4. How does truth open the door to a life of genuine freedom in Christ?

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